Charles F. Aust, Ph.D.,
[redacted]

April 22, 2025

Ladies and Gentlemen:

I am very pleased to offer this recommendation to enthusiastically support the graduate school application of Jack Hagler for the online MBA (iMBA) in the Gies College of Business.

I have known Jack since spring semester 2018 when he was a student in my COM 2020 course, COM Sources and Investigations, at Kennesaw State University, where I served as a full-time faculty member for 24 years in the School of Communication & Media until my retirement in the summer of 2019.

Jack has kept in touch with me regularly and I am very familiar with his professional accomplishments since his graduation in 2020.

I have no doubt Jack could succeed in graduate school. He is competent, thoughtful and courteous, manages his time well, is able to delay gratification and persevere in demanding situations. While a student in my course, he overcame a severe allergic case of poison ivy, which led to an infection that developed into sepsis and gangrene. He was in the hospital and bedridden for weeks yet was able to progress in his course work, which he completed successfully in my course as well as 3 other courses.

Effective communication and productive work habits are key to grad school success. Jack's communication skills and work habits are

excellent. He effectively and creatively expresses himself both orally and in writing, works diligently, and maintains high standards. He has the ability to analyze, synthesize, summarize, and produce with great attention to detail, accuracy, and thoroughness, as exhibited by his professional track record since graduation in 2020. These abilities would serve him well in graduate school. Of special note, he and a colleague grew a business within 2 years to have more than 100 clients.

Jack is well equipped to handle the scholarly rigor and the flexible timetable of this online program.

I have full confidence that Jack will continue to apply himself with determination and dedication to learning, growing, and giving of himself both personally and professionally. Jack has a caring empathic heart and I believe he will continue to contribute to the well-being of others. I am honored to call him a friend as well as an accomplished former student.

I recommend Jack without any reservations. Thank you for your attention and efforts to consider my input in your important decision-making process. Please feel free to call on me if you need more information or have questions.

Sincerely,

Charles F. Aust, Ph.D,
Professor Emeritus,
School of Communication & Media
Kennesaw State University
Phone: 770-517-0725
caust@kennesaw.edu